

**DEPARTMENT OF VETERANS AFFAIRS**

**SOLE SOURCE JUSTIFICATION UNDER SIMPLIFIED PROCEDURES FOR CERTAIN COMMERCIAL ITEMS IN  
ACCORDANCE WITH FAR 13.5**

**Acquisition Plan Action ID: 36C241-25-AP-2170**

1. **Contracting Activity:** Network Contracting Office 1, Regional Procurement Office East on Behalf of the Department of Veterans Affairs, VISN 1, West Haven VA Medical Center 950 Campbell Avenue West Haven, CT 06516-2770. Funding 689-25-2-7201-0022.
2. **Nature and/or Description of the Action Being Processed:** This action is a new, firm fixed, sole source requirement. The VA Connecticut Healthcare System, West Haven Campus has a need for continuation of services for a mobile sterile processing (SPS) unit onsite under contract GS -30F - 022GA 36C24124F0087, to ensure the reliable, and continued operation of the medical center sterile processing service. The SPS department must be operational and fully functional to support current patient care needs. The rationale for sole source is that an open competitive contract would bring in an entirely new physical trailer to the already built dock and passageway. Continuation rental of a mobile reprocessing unit (trailer) for a period of approximately 60 months is required while the existing sterile processing area is still under construction.  
Period of Performance: (1) Base Year plus (4) Option Years  
Base Year: 03/10/2025 – 03/09/2026  
Option Year 1: 03/10/2026 – 03/09/2027  
Option Year 2: 03/10/2027 – 03/09/2028  
Option Year 3: 03/10/2028 – 03/09/2029  
Option Year 4: 03/10/2029 – 03/09/2030  
3. **Description of Supplies/Services Required to Meet the Agency's Needs:** The STERIS Mobile SPS Trailer is a stand-alone trailer system that provides a complete alternate Sterilization site for the facility. It contains both a dirty and clean processing space. It provides its own critical water, steam generation and isolation areas for proper processing. The current STERIS SPS mobile trailer unit has been a critical piece of the West Haven, CT medical center since 2020. This unit is self-sufficient and allows SPS to maintain full operations when their main location is under renovations, repairs, or other equipment failures. The trailer unit has provided this critical redundancy on countless occasions at West Haven. Estimated Total Value including Base and All Option  
4. **Statutory Authority Permitting Restricted Competition:**  
FAR 13.5 Simplified Procedures for Certain Commercial Items. The statutory authority for applying the Simplified Procedures for Commercial Items of FAR 13.5 is 41 U.S.C. § 1901 and is implemented by FAR 13.106-1(b)(2) for restricting competition on this procurement. **Competition is restricted on this procurement for the reason below:**

- (X) Only One Responsible Source and No Other Supplies or Services Will Satisfy Agency Requirements
- ( ) Unusual and Compelling Urgency

Effective Date: 11/15/24

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**REVISION: 01**

**Acquisition ID#: 36C241-25-AP-2170**

VHAPG Part 813.5 Simplified Acquisition Procedures for Certain Commercial Items  
Request for Sole Source Justification >SAT-\$7.5M under FAR13.5

- ( ) Industrial Mobilization, Engineering, Developmental or Research Capability or Expert Services
- ( ) International Agreement
- ( ) Authorized or Required by Statute
- ( ) National Security
- ( ) Public Interest

5. **Demonstration that the Contractor's Unique Qualifications or Nature of the Acquisition Requires the Use of the Authority Cited Above (applicability of authority):** Only One Responsible Source (STERIS Corporation) can be utilized for continuing these services. The rationale for sole-source is that an open competitive contract would bring in an entirely new physical trailer to the already built dock and passageway. There would be an immediate cost to modify the existing trailer infrastructure to a new unit. Trailer entry & exit points would have to be reframed and sealed, all the utility connections would have to be studied and re-connected. New electrical requirements would demand new conductors and switchgear. There is also the unique Sterile Space requirement of this trailer. The seals from the building egress to the trailer unit are tightly sealed. There has been continuous work to ensure this connection remains watertight. STERIS had added a large custom membrane to provide additional water protection. As any slight movement or finite changes occur, water penetration into this sterile space is expected. Keeping the existing unit in place will not jeopardize the water protection and air-tight connection already established. The imminent cost in physically installing a new trailer unit would overshadow ...the more beneficial choice in keeping the existing STERIS unit in place with a new contract. A new Trailer would incur hours and weeks of training for the SPS staff. The strength of the existing Steris trailer is that the SPS staff can transition to the Mobile Trailer unit at a moment's notice. All of their equipment and protocols are in place to easily utilize the Steris Unit. Having to re-train, modify, re-stock and familiarize the SPS staff to a new unit would only jeopardize their ability to maintain Sterilization service for the entire Medical Facility. This directly affects everything from routine treatments to emergency surgeries.
6. **Description of Efforts Made to ensure that offers are solicited from as many potential sources as deemed practicable:** There is very limited competition available meeting the same criteria and performance as STERIS in these capabilities. As stated, a new vendor would also incur major site adjustments that would quickly elevate costs with no real benefit to the government in either cost or performance. West Haven's FMS COR, Cornelius Finnegan IV researched alternate vendors such as, *Odulair*, or *Belimed* that would not provide a feasible alternative with respects to time, cost, and most importantly, service-support. Other alternate vendors present a 3<sup>rd</sup> party development of mobile units using equipment and parts sourced from several vendors. There is simply not enough available competition to match the continued performance of the STERIS mobile unit in place.
7. **Determination by the CO that the Anticipated Cost to the Government will be Fair and Reasonable:** The anticipated cost of this new lease will be considered fair and reasonable in comparison to previous proposed pricing from STERIS Corporation for the current lease ending on 03/09/2025 under contract number GS-30F-022GA 36C24124F0087. The base year of this new contract will be the same pricing for the previous year under the contract mentioned above and moving forward for each option year there will be 4.87% which is reasonable with inflation.

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8. **Description of the Market Research Conducted and the Results, or a Statement of the Reasons Market Research Was Not Conducted:** Market research was not conducted due to the proprietary factors surrounding this trailer. This acquisition will be a sole-source award for the lease continuation of the current SPS Trailer in place at West Haven VAMC.
9. **Any Other Facts Supporting the Use of Other than Full and Open Competition:** West Haven SPS would be impacted in not having an immediate – ready backup Sterilization unit that the current model provides. A new model would require lengthy training for all staff and further impact overall readiness for the Medical Center. The Current main Sterilization department is located in the Sub Ground level of the main Hospital, Building One. This location has been continuously degraded due to major steam system leaks, repairs, and renovations. There are aging power, steam, and water facilities that can regularly impact the main SPS area several times a year. In 2024 alone, major steam leaks required that SPS relocate staff during repairs. If the VA West Haven hadn't had the STERIS mobile unit onsite, the entire facility could have had to divert or cancel major procedures. Progress in securing a new SPS site is slow and there is critical need to retain the current STERIS mobile unit as a proven alternate Sterilization location. There are current minor & major projects being developed that may render the need for the mobile trailer obsolete. By extending the sole source option to continue using the STERIS unit, the VA will have the option to cancel any contractual option years once this permanent facility is in place.
10. **Listing of Sources that Expressed, in Writing, an Interest in the Acquisition:** STERIS Corporation expressed their interest in writing on Friday, January 10, 2025, 11:35 AM via email to the station.
11. **A Statement of the Actions, if any, the Agency May Take to Remove or Overcome any Barriers to Competition before Making subsequent acquisitions for the supplies or services required:** No actions are currently planned, however West Haven's SPS Staff will plan to work on a contingency plan for future procurements involving unforeseen circumstances that affect patient safety as well as research new and innovative technology for sterile processing that may better outcomes for unexpected department delays.
12. **Requirements Certification:** I certify that the requirement outlined in this justification is a Bona Fide Need of the Department of Veterans Affairs and that the supporting data under my cognizance, which are included in the justification, are accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.

**CORNELIUS  
FINNEGAN** Digitally signed by  
CORNELIUS FINNEGAN  
Date: 2025.02.20  
08:35:52 -05'00'

Cornelius Finnegan IV  
Engineering Technician  
VA Connecticut Healthcare System

\_\_\_\_\_  
Date

VHAPG Part 813.5 Simplified Acquisition Procedures for Certain Commercial Items  
Request for Sole Source Justification >SAT-\$7.5M under FAR13.5

13. Approvals in accordance with the [VHAPM Part 806.3 OFOC SOP](#):

- a. Contracting Officer or Designee's Certification (required): I certify that the foregoing justification is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.

**GAIL GRUNDY**  
Digitally signed by  
GAIL GRUNDY  
Date: 2025.02.20  
11:09:34 -05'00'

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Gail Grundy  
Contracting Officer  
NCO 1/RPO EAST

\_\_\_\_\_  
Date

- b. One Level Above the Contracting Officer (Required over SAT but not exceeding \$750K): I certify the justification meets requirements for other than full and open competition.

**CORY DIONNE**  
Digitally signed by CORY DIONNE  
Date: 2025.02.21 07:35:17 -05'00'

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Cory Dionne  
Branch Chief  
NCO 1/RPO EAST

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Date

- c. VHA RPO HCA Review and Approval: I have reviewed the foregoing justification and find it to be complete and accurate to the best of my knowledge and belief and approve (\$750K to \$7.5 million (or \$15.0 million for acquisitions described in FAR 13.500(c)) for other than full and open competition.

**GERALD JACOBS**  
Digitally signed by GERALD  
JACOBS  
Date: 2025.03.06 10:26:58 -05'00'

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Gerald F. Jacobs  
Executive Director, Regional Procurement Office East  
VHA Head of Contracting Activity (HCA)

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Date